

field of ghosts

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Premise: Set in a fantasy action RPG, the following set of scenes play out over the course of a side quest.

Note: For the sake of brevity, assume the player character (HUNTER) has received a quest summoning them to Lord Talin's House.

INT. LORD TALIN'S HOUSE - DAY

HUNTER enters a lavish room, a soft fire burns at the fire place. A portly man, TALIN, stands by it, sipping red wine.

TALIN

Ah good, you're finally here. Tell me Hunter, do you care for our summers?

HUNTER

Summer or winter, there's always monsters to hunt.

TALIN

How pragmatic. Well, I for one can't stand them. Which is why I wish to build a home near the mountains.

HUNTER

Great, what do you need me for?

TALIN

The land I own there is... infested. Damned *shades* won't let my builders work. I'd like you to take care of them. Do that Hunter, and you will need a second purse to fit the coin I will pay you.

Hunter nods before departing. A notification indicates the 'Field of Ghosts' quest is now active.

EXT. MOUNTAIN SIDE - NIGHT

Hunter arrives at a large field. A single burnt down structure sits in the middle. On the ground, the player's special vision lets them see three sets of partially burnt remains.

HUNTER

Seems like an incomplete cremation.

When the player chooses to interact with the remains, Hunter tries to set the remains on fire. But the fire flickers away.

Instead, THREE silent SHADES form above the site. One is a hunchback, the second is an Elf, and the third is human woman. They stare at Hunter.

HUNTER (cont'd)
What happened here? Why do you
resist your cremation?

The shades continue to stare. Wordlessly.

HUNTER (cont'd)
Well if you can't be cremated, I
suppose I could bury your remains?

The shades nod.

HUNTER (cont'd)
Very well. Guide me to your homes.

The Player gets three sub-quests, one for each place a set of remains needs to be returned to.

EXT. SHADE 1 HOUSE - DAY

Hunter walks up to the young man DARREN chopping wood outside a house.

HUNTER
This is going to sound strange,
but I have the remains of someone
who used to live here. Need to
bury them so they can find peace.

DARREN
Who sent you, is this another one
of Jack's jokes?

HUNTER
No joke. Here see for yourself.

Hunter puts the remains down and the Shade of the woman appears. She looks pleadingly at Darren.

DARREN
You! Monster!

Darren kicks the remains, making the shade disappear.

HUNTER
Not often a dead person inspires
such anger. What did she do?

DARREN
She was a changeling! They took
her away but the town's people
still whisper a prayer when they
see me go by.

(MORE)

DARREN (cont'd)

How was her five year old son
supposed to know his mother was
evil?

HUNTER

Those aren't changeling remains,
they are human.

DARREN

Like the townsfolk would care.
Please, leave! And take her with
you!

HUNTER

Can't. Only way to be rid of her
is to bury her. Let me in to your
yard, and I'll do it.

DARREN

No no, hand her over. If they see
a stranger digging the ground near
my place, it will only raise more
questions.

Hunter nods. One of the sub quests is complete.

EXT. JOHN'S HOUSE - DAY

An old woman, JIA, rests on the front porch in a rocking
chair.

JIA

If you're looking to buy my
pickles, come back tomorrow.

HUNTER

I've come to lay a shade to rest,
a hunchback, did you know him?

JIA

(tearing up)
John? He didn't find rest?

HUNTER

So it would seem.

JIA

He had done nothing wrong. I told
those soldiers, but they said it
he had to have used dark magic to
be cursed with that body.

HUNTER

Not have magic works...

JIA

That's what I told them! But, you said you have come to lay him to rest?

HUNTER

His spirit has been haunting the execution ground. Laying him to rest at his home will let him move on.

JIA

Hand him here. I took care of him when our mother worked, only right I lay him to rest.

Hunter completes another sub-quest.

EXT. JEAN'S HOUSE - DAY

A middle-aged human woman, NEELAM, is sweeping the floor outside the house.

HUNTER

Was this once home to an elven woman?

NEELAM

Come any closer and this broom will find its way through you.

HUNTER

Peace lady. The elf's spirit has been haunting the ground she was executed on.

NEELAM

(laughing)

Serves that Talin right. I'm glad my Jean is giving him a hard time.

HUNTER

Her life force led me here, must mean this is where she considers home. I've come to lay her to rest.

NEELAM

This was not her home. But it is where we came to live after our families could not abide by our human-elf bond.

HUNTER

I'm sorry you had to go through that.

NEELAM

That's kind of you to say. Hand her here, I'll make sure she is buried properly. And my friends will know to bury me next to her when the time comes.

Hunter nods. Another sub-quest complete.

INT. LORD TALIN'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Talin waits by the fireplace. Comfortable.

HUNTER

The field is cleansed.

TALIN

I knew I could count on you.

HUNTER

That was a lot of *monsters* you burnt.

TALIN

I had to protect my people, it was my duty.

HUNTER

Your duty. Heh. Some would say it was your duty to make sure you didn't execute innocents.

TALIN

People who say that would find their heads separated from their bodies. Take the gold and begone, Hunter.

Player can choose to accept the coin or push back. The following shows the dialogues if they push back.

HUNTER

No.

TALIN

No?

HUNTER

First tell me why. Why murder innocents? Why accuse elves, and cripples, and simple women of dark magic?

TALIN

Because the crops failed that year! Most of the farms had a quarter of their usual produce.

(MORE)

TALIN (cont'd)

Yet my King demanded I pay taxes.
I didn't wish to earn his ire. But
if I collected the taxes, the
villagers would hate me. So...I
gave them something else to be
angry about. They readily blamed
those abominations, and thanked me
for saving them by paying the
taxes without complain.

HUNTER

Could have paid from your personal
stores. You seem to have enough.

TALIN

Why would I do that? It was easier
to kill a few commoners. No one
would miss them? Now...are we done
here?

Player can accept the gold or choose to fight Talin. If
he fights and kills Talin, he becomes wanted by the guard
for the time being.